

BACKGROUND GUIDE FOR IP JOURNALISM

Greetings Members of the International Press!

We welcome you to the **International Press Committee of YUGEN 6.0**.

The International Press is an often-overlooked yet highly esteemed and essential committee. As a member of the International Press, whether as a reporter or photojournalist, your role is to act as a bridge between the conference and the wider public.

You are entrusted with the responsibility of conveying not only facts and briefings but also compelling stories that highlight the significance of diplomacy.

On behalf of the Secretariat and the Executive Board, we extend our warmest regards and wish each of you the very best as members of the International Press.

Thank you.

Shreyal Kothapalli (Head of International Press)

Prasatti Burli (Editor-in-Chief)

"Journalism is merely history's first draft."

— Geoffrey Ward

Guidelines for Writing

1. Idea

Every article begins with an idea. Reporters will be assigned to a specific committee (such as the UNSC or DISEC). Submissions should be inspired by the proceedings, discussions, and agenda of the assigned committee, but need not be limited to them.

2. Free

Reporters are independent. We have intentionally chosen not to assign news agencies, allowing each journalist complete editorial freedom and discretion. Write what you believe is newsworthy, provided it is appropriate and parliamentary.

3. Third Person

Unless writing a creative piece, submissions are recommended to be written in the third person.

4. Attribution

All factual claims, statistics, and evidence must be properly attributed to their sources. ***Reporters are strongly advised to avoid plagiarism and refrain from using AI-generated content.***

5. Record

Reporters are not expected to document every aspect of committee proceedings, such as lunch breaks or unmoderated caucuses. Instead,

focus on recording and reporting significant developments from formal sessions using your own editorial judgment.

6. Abbreviations:

Before abbreviating, mention the whole name and then the abbreviation in parentheses. Example: “The Non- Proliferation Treaty (NPT).”

7. Official names:

State the official name recognized by the United Nations and then in parenthesis, mention the unofficial name of the country.

Example: People’s Republic of China (PRC/China).

8. Diplomacy

As a journalist, you will have to stick to diplomacy. Anything you write/say should be diplomatic and not hurt the sentiments of any nation. Our role as reporters is to form the bridge between public and global affairs.

Document Formatting Guidelines

File Submission

- File format: [.docx](#)
- File naming convention: [Name_Type_Committee_Day1](#)

Font - Times New Roman throughout the document.

Title

- Font size: 14 pt
- Bold
- No italics
- No underline
- Make it catchy and attention worthy

Byline

- Font size: 13 pt
- Italicized
- Not bold
- Example byline: YOUR FIRST AND LAST NAME, reporting from
YOUR RESPECTIVE COMMITTEE about _____

Body Text

- Font size: 12 pt
- Regular (no bold or italics unless specifically required)
- Times New Roman
- Line Spacing 1.5

Alignment

Text alignment for the main body of articles should be justified, while headings, titles, and bylines are typically centered or left-aligned.

Submissions (Type of Articles)

1. Beat-Based Article:

A beat is simply a short article of around 250-300 words revolving around a specific subject. A beat may capture a particular aspect of the committee, taking lines from certain delegates and associating it with wider diplomatic implications, Etc. Beats are recommended to be statistical, in the sense that it incorporates either direct verbatim of delegate speeches, or inclusion of facts and credible sources to defend the crux of the beat. Personal opinions are recommended to be steered away from beats.

Stages of Writing Beat:

- I. Identifying Beat topic
- II. Noting quotes/ attributing facts and sources
- III. Written piece (no paragraph restrictions)

2. Opinion Editorials:

Opinion Editorials are articles of 450 to 600 words wherein journalists are expected to express their own point of view. Op-Eds can be based on the agenda of the committee or the interim discussion. Here, the journalist talks not only about the discussion at hand but also offers their own point of view.

3. Creative Piece:

Creative pieces are works that lie completely within the journalist's creative agency. Creatives are based on anything that happened in committee, agenda, and anything else up to their discretion. The submission format of any creative form will be specified by the Executive Board.

4. Interview:

An interview is an article that provides reporters with an opportunity to interview a delegate or EB member. It is a chance to delve deeper into the agenda or gain insight into the views of the interviewee. (350-500 words).

The objective of Interviews are to probe deeper into the delegate's perspective and policy beyond committee discussion. The number of questions asked should be minimal but significant. Reporters may interview the delegates or even the Executive Board during breaks or lobbying sessions. Reporters must maintain professionalism throughout the interview and respect interviewees time and comfort. A reporter's goal should be to obtain accurate and clear answers to questions that are relevant and remain well within the boundaries of the committee.

5. Press Conference:

A press conference is when a reporter or member of the International Press comes to the committee and asks questions to the delegates present. The main purpose of a press conference is to assess whether delegates have a keen and in-depth understanding of the agenda. It holds the delegates accountable for what they've said and promotes a deeper understanding of the perspectives within the committee. Source based questions and follow ups are encouraged to promote engaging discussions. Professionalism is expected of both reporters and delegates.

Any additional collaborative report/article submissions will be communicated by the Executive Board during committee proceedings.

Marking Scheme

Journalists should keep the following evaluation parameters in mind while preparing their submissions:

- Creativity
- Grammar
- Vocabulary
- Formatting
- Clarity of Thought
- Originality
- Discipline (Timely submissions)

Do NOT hesitate while having queries. Any discomfort you have or any issues that come up, do NOT be afraid. Let us know immediately, and we will do our best to help you out.

All the best.